

VIT Bhopal University
CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

PROJECT REPORT

Name	Utkarsh Kankane
Registration Number	25BCE10695
Branch	Computer Science Engineering (CSE)
Year	First Year – B.Tech
Course Code	CSE0001 – Digital Literacy
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Introduction

This project report is submitted as part of the CSE0001 – Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. The project follows the scenario of being selected as a Student Digital Ambassador, with the responsibility of helping peers navigate the digital world confidently and safely.

The project is organized into five tasks, each corresponding to a module of the course: creating a digital literacy infographic, building a student digital portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration platforms, drafting professional emails and an etiquette guide, and conducting a cybercrime awareness case study. All work has been compiled into a GitHub repository and documented in this report.

The goal of this assignment is not merely academic — it is to build real, lasting digital skills and an online presence that will serve throughout my engineering career and beyond.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Tool Used

I used Canva AI to create the digital literacy infographic. Canva is a free, browser-based graphic design platform that offers a wide range of templates, icons, and AI-assisted design features. The AI feature helped me generate an aesthetically structured layout while I focused on the content.

What the Design Shows

The infographic is titled 'Digital Literacy Basics' and covers three key topics as required by the task:

- **What is Digital Literacy** – This section explains that digital literacy means having the skills to find, understand, create, and communicate digital information safely and effectively. It is illustrated with an image of a person working on a laptop surrounded by digital icons.
- **Useful Digital Tools for Students** – This section highlights tools such as note-taking apps, online calendars, and collaborative documents, emphasizing how these tools help students organize and collaborate anytime, anywhere.
- **Safe Internet Practices** – This section advises students to use strong passwords, think before sharing, and always verify trustworthy sites for online safety.

The design uses a clean, color-coded layout with three distinct panels, making it visually accessible and easy to understand at a glance.

Reflection

One thing I found particularly interesting was how Canva AI suggested layout structures that balanced text and visuals without making the design feel cluttered. The most challenging part was deciding how much information to include — digital literacy is a broad topic, and condensing it into a single infographic without losing important detail required careful prioritization. I also experimented with different color themes

before settling on the current green-blue-orange palette, which felt both professional and student-friendly.

Task 2: Student Digital Portfolio

Platforms Set Up

For this task, I created and configured profiles on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each platform serves a distinct professional purpose.

- GitHub (username: utkarsh25bce10695) – GitHub is a version control and code hosting platform widely used by developers, open-source contributors, and engineering students. I created a profile README repository that introduces me as a first-year CSE student, states my goal of developing scalable web applications and contributing to open-source software, and invites visitors to explore my repositories.
- LinkedIn (Utkarsh Kankane) – LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform. It is used by employers, internship coordinators, and industry professionals. I set up my profile with my current role as a student at VIT Bhopal University, location (Uttar Pradesh, India), and have 57 connections so far.
- Kaggle (utkarshkankane) – Kaggle is a platform for data science, machine learning competitions, datasets, and community learning. I registered as a student at VIT Bhopal with a bio stating: 'Computer Science & Engineering student passionate about AI, statistics, and solving complex problems through data.' I have been active on the platform for 5 months.

How I Plan to Use These Platforms

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub as my primary portfolio — committing academic projects, personal experiments, and open-source contributions so that by my final year it reflects a genuine body of work. LinkedIn will be used to connect with seniors, apply for internships, and document achievements and certifications. Kaggle will serve as my learning and practice ground for data science, where I will participate in competitions and work through datasets as I develop my analytical skills.

Task 3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Part A – Coding Practice: HackerRank

I created an account on HackerRank and completed the 'Python If-Else' challenge under the Python > Introduction section. The problem required writing conditional logic to determine whether a given integer is 'Weird' or 'Not Weird' based on its value and parity. I successfully passed all test cases (Test cases 0 through 5) and earned 10.00 points, bringing my Python badge progress to 43% (15 out of 35 points toward the first star).

HackerRank is a competitive programming platform that helps students practice problem-solving skills in multiple programming languages. It is widely used by companies during recruitment to assess candidates' coding ability.

Part B – Google Workspace: Digital Literacy Awareness Survey

I created a Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Survey' with the following five questions:

- Name (Short answer) – to identify respondents.
- Registration Number (Short answer) – to link responses to students.
- Email ID (Short answer) – for follow-up if needed.
- When you receive a message with a suspicious link, what do you usually do? (Multiple choice) – options include: Click it out of curiosity, Ignore it, Check the sender and verify before clicking, Forward it to friends.
- Rate on Scale (1-5): How confident are you in identifying online scams or fake websites? (Linear scale, 1 = Not confident at all, 5 = Very confident).
- Which of the following actions do you personally take to stay safe online? (Checkboxes) – Use the same password for all accounts, Enable two-factor authentication, Regularly update apps and software, Share personal information on social media, Avoid clicking on unknown links.
- Describe a situation where you felt unsure about the safety of something online. What did you do? (Short answer).
- I believe that my personal data online is not valuable enough for hackers to target. (True/False).

The form was shared with batchmates and collected 5 responses. Key findings: 4 out of 5 respondents said they check the sender before clicking suspicious links; most rated their scam-detection confidence at 3-4 out of 5; 4 out of 5 enable two-factor authentication and avoid unknown links; and only 2 out of 5 correctly identified that personal data IS valuable to hackers (3 chose 'True,' which is the incorrect/risky belief).

Reflection

These platforms will be academically invaluable. HackerRank prepares me for technical interviews and sharpens algorithmic thinking. Google Forms taught me how to design structured surveys — a skill useful for academic research, project feedback, and even data collection for ML projects. Running a real survey also gave me insight into how classmates perceive online safety, revealing genuine gaps in awareness that affirm why digital literacy education matters.

Task 4: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Part A – Email 1: Assignment Extension Request

Subject: Request for Extension on Assignment Submission – CSE0201

Dear Professor [Name],

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to respectfully request a short extension on the upcoming assignment for CSE0201, currently due on [date]. I have

been experiencing [brief genuine reason, e.g., a medical issue / difficulty with a particular concept] and want to ensure that I submit work that reflects a genuine understanding of the material rather than a rushed effort.

I would be grateful if I could have an additional [2-3 days] to complete the submission. I am happy to discuss this further at your convenience.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Utkarsh Kankane | 25BCE10695 | B.Tech CSE, Year 1 | VIT Bhopal University

Part A – Email 2: Internship Interest

Subject: Application for Summer Internship Opportunity – Computer Science Engineering Student

Dear [Coordinator's Name],

I am Utkarsh Kankane, a first-year B.Tech student in Computer Science Engineering at VIT Bhopal University (Registration No. 25BCE10695). I am writing to express my keen interest in a summer internship opportunity at [Company Name].

I am passionate about software development and data science, and I am eager to apply my foundational knowledge in a real-world environment. I believe an internship at your organization would be an invaluable opportunity to learn from experienced professionals and contribute meaningfully to your team.

Please find my GitHub profile attached for reference to my current projects. I would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss how I could contribute to your team this summer.

Thank you for considering my application.

Warm regards,

Utkarsh Kankane | utkarsh25bce10695@vitbhopal.ac.in |
github.com/utkarsh25bce10695

Part B – Social Media Do's and Don'ts

The following checklist is for responsible social media use as a college student:

DO's:

- Keep your professional profiles (LinkedIn, GitHub) updated and complete.
- Use a strong, unique password for each social media account.
- Enable two-factor authentication on all platforms.
- Think carefully before posting — ask yourself if you would be comfortable with a future employer seeing it.
- Report harmful, abusive, or suspicious content using the platform's built-in reporting tools.

DON'Ts:

- Do not share your phone number, address, or financial information publicly.
- Do not engage with or repost unverified news or inflammatory content.
- Do not accept friend/connection requests from people you do not know.
- Do not post photos or comments that could be perceived as discriminatory or unprofessional.

- Do not use the same password across multiple platforms.

Communication Scenario

A realistic scenario illustrating poor digital communication: a student, frustrated after receiving a low grade, posts a public complaint on Twitter calling out their professor by name and using an aggressive tone. The tweet is noticed by classmates, shared widely, and eventually seen by the university administration. The student faces a disciplinary inquiry and the post damages their professional reputation just before internship season.

What could have been done differently: the student should have approached the professor privately via email, using a calm and respectful tone to seek clarification. Expressing academic concerns through proper channels — email or a formal grievance process — is always more effective and professional than public social media venting.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study

Part A – Case Study: Phishing

Phishing is one of the most common forms of cybercrime targeting college students and young adults in India. It involves an attacker posing as a trusted entity — such as a bank, university, or government body — to trick the victim into revealing sensitive information such as passwords, OTPs, or financial details.

How it typically happens: The attacker sends an email or WhatsApp message that appears to come from a legitimate source (e.g., the student's bank or college portal). The message creates urgency — for example, claiming the recipient's account will be blocked or a form must be filled immediately. The link in the message leads to a fake website that closely mimics the original. When the student enters their credentials or OTP, the attacker captures this data in real time and uses it to access accounts or drain funds.

Who is targeted: First-year students are particularly vulnerable due to their limited experience with online fraud. Students receiving scholarship money, stipends, or making their first UPI transactions are frequent targets.

Consequences: Victims may lose money, have their bank accounts compromised, or have their personal data sold. The emotional impact — shame, anxiety, loss of trust — can also be significant. In academic contexts, phishing can lead to unauthorized access to college portals and identity theft.

Real-world relevance: Survey responses from my Google Form (Task 3) showed that one student received a fake link for bank account verification and another received an email claiming their account was locked. Both cases match classic phishing patterns.

Part B – Stay Safe Online: Prevention Checklist

The following checklist contains actionable prevention tips specifically for college students in India:

- Never click on links in unsolicited emails, WhatsApp messages, or SMS — go directly to the official website instead.

- Always verify the sender's email address carefully — phishing emails often use domains like '@g00gle.com' instead of '@google.com'.
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA) on all important accounts including email, banking apps, and social media.
- Never share your OTP with anyone — no legitimate bank or government body will ever ask for it.
- UPI Safety: Set a daily transaction limit on your UPI app and enable transaction alerts via SMS.
- UPI Safety: Never scan QR codes sent by strangers or accept 'collect requests' from unknown numbers — receiving money never requires entering your PIN.
- Use a password manager and create unique passwords for every account — never reuse passwords.
- Keep your phone's operating system and apps updated to patch known security vulnerabilities.
- Report cybercrime incidents at the National Cyber Crime Portal: cybercrime.gov.in or call the 24x7 helpline: 1930.
- Do not install apps from unofficial sources or grant unnecessary permissions to apps on your phone.

Reflection

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how sophisticated phishing attacks have become — the fake websites are sometimes pixel-perfect replicas of real ones, making it extremely difficult for an untrained eye to spot the difference. I was also struck by how survey responses from my own batchmates reflected real phishing experiences, suggesting this is not a theoretical risk but an active one on campus.

One personal habit I will change as a result of this task: I will immediately enable UPI transaction limits and SMS alerts on my phone's payment app, and I will start verifying the URL in my browser bar every time I log into any financial service.

Conclusion

This project has been a genuinely educational experience that went beyond classroom theory. Through five interconnected tasks, I have built a professional digital presence (GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle), practiced coding on HackerRank, designed a real awareness survey, learned professional email communication, and developed a deeper understanding of cybercrime.

The most significant learning is that digital literacy is not a single skill — it is an ecosystem of habits, tools, and awareness that compound over time. The GitHub repository created for this project is not just a submission; it is the beginning of a professional portfolio that I intend to grow throughout my four years at VIT Bhopal and beyond.

References

- Canva – canva.com (used for Task 1 infographic)
- GitHub – github.com (profile: [utkarsh25bce10695](https://github.com/utkarsh25bce10695))
- LinkedIn – linkedin.com/in/utkarsh-kankane-3428a0371
- Kaggle – kaggle.com/utkarshkankane
- HackerRank – hackerrank.com (Python Introduction challenges)
- Google Forms – forms.google.com (Digital Literacy Awareness Survey)
- National Cyber Crime Portal – cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline – 1930 (Government of India, 24x7)